



Public Participation Plan

The City of Jackson considers public participation to be an integral part of planning decisions, including community development, residential/commercial/industrial development projects, parks and recreation activities, infrastructure projects, transportation initiatives, and critical services. This Public Participation Plan is designed to provide City leaders instruction on engagement and reporting results to keep key stakeholders and citizens informed. This Public Participation Plan does not supersede any requirements from federal or state funding sources but may be used to enhance said minimum requirements. Methods outlined here can be utilized by City Departments, boards/commissions, and City Council as they seeking public input on vital City projects.

Goals and Objectives

The City of Jackson

- Seeks broad, community-wide public participation for matters impacting the City and its residents. Proactive participation denotes early and continuous involvement in important policy or project decisions before they are finalized. Opportunities for the public to play a role in shaping short- and long-term needs, solutions, and funding priorities will be initiated as early in the process as possible. Participation components will continue to be incorporated to foster extensive public input.
- Evaluates each project on an individual basis to determine project scope, project limitations, approving body, stakeholders, points of community impact during the decision-making process, internal and external resources, and level of appropriate community involvement.
- Makes information available in a timely manner to enable interested parties to be involved in decisions at various stages of the review and approval process.
- Engages citizens in a transparent manner, making information easy to access for all interested members of the community.
- Seeks creative ways to involve a diverse set of community stakeholders in planning, land use, development decisions, and significant future projects.
- Uses comments and information received from interested members of the community to make decisions regarding planning, land use, redevelopments, and future projects.

Key Stakeholders in the City of Jackson

Each project is evaluated on an individual basis to ensure inclusion of citizens, business owners, property owners, and others that may be impacted. Public participation may vary with each project according to the project being reviewed, as well as required public notice in accordance with federal, state or local rules and regulations.

Key stakeholders include, but are not limited to:

- Churches
- City boards/commissions
- Jackson City Council
- Civic and social organizations
- Health care facilities
- Industrial business owners
- County of Jackson government
- Region 2 Planning Commission
- MLK Corridor Improvement Authority
- Accelerate Jackson County (formerly The Enterprise Group)
- Local residents
- Local schools
- Michigan Department of Environment, Great Lakes and Energy
- Michigan Department of Transportation
- Michigan Department of Natural Resources
- Neighborhood groups
- Neighboring communities
- Office and commercial business owners
- Real estate professionals
- Senior groups
- Utility providers
- Other interested citizens as identified and appropriate

Public Notice Requirements – Local Ordinances and State Statutes

The following local and state regulations pertain to various planning processes and project design, and must be followed to ensure the required public notice for each respective project is followed. The intent is to encourage public participation:

- Jackson City Charter
- City of Jackson Code of Ordinances
- Michigan Open Meetings Act (PA 267 of 1976, as amended)
- Home Rule City Act (PA 279 of 1909, as amended)
- Michigan Planning Enabling Act (PA 33 of 2008, as amended)
- Plant Rehabilitation and Industrial Development (PA 198 of 1974, as amended)
- Brownfield Redevelopment Financing Act (PA 381 of 1996, as amended)
- Downtown Development Authority Act (PA 197 of 1975, as amended)
- Local Development Finance Authority Act (PA 281 of 1986, as amended)
- Other applicable federal, state and local regulation

Planning and Development Review Entities

- *City Council* – the Jackson City Council is comprised of seven (7) members consisting of a Mayor, Vice-Mayor, and five (5) Councilmembers. For most planning and development review processes (excluding variances and most site plans), the Jackson City Council is the legislative and policy-making body providing final approval.
- *Planning Commission* – The Planning Commission is a six (6) member body appointed by the Mayor, subject to approval by a majority vote of the Jackson City Council. To the extent possible, members represent different professions or occupations and all except one (1) shall be qualified electors of the City of Jackson. The Planning Commission is also comprised of ex officio members: the Mayor, the City Manager or his/her designee, and one (1) member of City Council. The Regional Planning Director may also be appointed as an advisory and non-voting member. The Planning Commission's primary

responsibility is to guide land use development, policy and growth that best meets the City of Jackson's goals. This work is steered by the City's Master Plan, economic trends, initiatives and community efforts and/or by changes in state and local legislature.

- *Zoning Board of Appeals* – The Zoning Board of Appeals (ZBA) shall hear and decide only such matters as the board is specifically authorized. The ZBA has the power to grant variances, decide appeals on administrative decisions, and to interpret the boundary lines of the zoning map. The ZBA does not have the power to alter or change the zoning district classification of any property.

The following boards meet regularly or as needed in response to a development or redevelopment project, providing additional opportunity for public participation in the planning and development review process:

- *Downtown Development Authority* – the Downtown Development Authority (DDA) is governed by a volunteer Board of Directors consisting of the Mayor and twelve other members appointed by the Mayor with the approval of the City Council. The Board members represent businesses, property owners, and residents of the community. The principal purpose of the DDA is to encourage historic preservation, create and implement development plans, promote economic growth and correct and prevent deterioration in the District.
- *Jackson Brownfield Redevelopment Authority* – the Jackson Brownfield Redevelopment Authority (JBRA) promotes the revitalization of environmentally distressed areas and facilitates the implementation of Brownfield Plans relating to the designation and treatment of Brownfield Redevelopment zones. The authority oversees the use of tax increment financing on select properties, such as former industrial and commercial sites, that need special attention to be redeveloped. Taxes from these properties are captured to fund redevelopment.

A comprehensive list of Boards and Commissions is found on the City's website [Boards & Commissions | Jackson, MI - Official Website](#) and included as **Attachment A**. Community members interested in active civic engagement are encouraged to apply for openings on these boards and commissions.

Open Meetings Act

All meetings of the Jackson City Council, boards and commissions shall be open to the public in accordance with the Open Meetings Act (PA 267 OF 1976, as amended), except closed session meetings as provided for in the Act. Every open meeting must also provide an opportunity for citizen comment. Public notices for open meetings are posted at City Hall as required by the Act. In addition, the dates and times of all City Council, board and commission meetings are posted to the City of Jackson website at [Calendar • City Meeting and Event Calendar](#). The agendas are available on the City website in advance of all meetings; meeting minutes are posted to the City website after approval here: [Agendas and Minutes | Jackson, MI - Official Website](#). Finally, City Council meetings can be viewed live through local channel JTV or live streaming through the City's Facebook page at <https://www.facebook.com/search/top?q=city%20of%20jackson%2C%20michigan%20government>. Recorded meetings are televised and replayed on local cable access, and available on demand through YouTube and the City's Facebook page.

Public Hearings

As noted above, all City Council, board and commission meetings are open meetings. Several planning and development review processes also require a public hearing during the meeting and require public notices prior to the meeting in accordance with local ordinance and/or state statute relevant to the project. The following processes require a public hearing during the regular meeting that is open to the public:

Planning Commission

- Zoning map amendments/rezoning(including discretionary rezoning approvals)¹
- Zoning text amendment¹
- Subdivision plats¹
- Site condominiums¹
- Tentative and conceptual plan amendments for zoning districts¹
- Master Plan amendments²
- Special land use permits
- Active home occupations
- Building height modifications
- Accessory buildings in excess of the ground floor living area of the dwelling

ZBA:

- Variance requests
- Text or map interpretations
- Temporary use permits
- Appeals of administrative decisions

DDA, JBRA:

- Amended Development Plans/Tax Increment Financing Plans¹
- Brownfield Redevelopment Plans¹

¹ *these items are recommended to City Council for a public hearing and final action.*

² *Master Plan amendments do not require a public hearing before City Council but are referred to City Council for review. A resolution of approval by City Council is not required by state statute.*

Statutes require the above review and approval processes be noticed in a newspaper of general circulation as well as mailed to neighbors within 300 feet at least 15 days prior to the meeting. The City may increase the mailing distance up to 500 feet for a hearing on a proposed plan that has a broader or more significant impact that justifies a more extended notification process than the minimum of 300 feet required by state law. All meetings are held in a facility accessible to persons with disabilities and the City will provide reasonable accommodations or services to individuals with disabilities.

Methods for Community Participation

The initial evaluation of each project will determine the level of public outreach for the project. The following are methods that may be used to reach the appropriate level of public participation for future planning and relevant projects. For projects that have a city-wide impact, the City of Jackson will always attempt to use more than one tool or method, depending on the specific project and target audience. This list is flexible and can change based on the needs of the project.

Inform – Provide Information

- Printed postings – all public meetings and public hearings will have printed notices available for view on the City Hall lobby board.
- Digital media includes, but is not limited to, City of Jackson website [Jackson, MI - Official Website | Official Website](#), Facebook page and other social media outlets. Other digital media options include online surveys.
- Community outreach through public meetings, town halls, Ward meetings, community events, neighborhood forums and quarterly newsletters.
- Traditional media - the City issues press releases and participates in media interviews with various newspapers and television stations pertaining to community-wide planning projects. The *Jackson Citizen Patriot* is the local newspaper in general circulation; local channel JTV is available on Comcast channel 90, Wow! channel 161, AT&T U-verse channel 5380, Springcom channel 9-1, Zeam, Youtube, FireTV, Apple TV, and Roku. Additional local media includes, but is not limited to WILX (NBC), WLNS (CBS), WLAJ (ABC), FOX 47, and WKHM.

Consult and Involve – Obtain Public Feedback

- Public Meetings and Public Hearings – public attendance at meetings is strongly encouraged and allows for an appropriate venue for public input.
- Surveys – utilizing online and paper surveys allows for the collection of large amounts of data and opinions from the public.
- Community Workshops and Ward Meetings – issues that require community feedback can benefit from community-wide workshops, focus group meetings, or Ward meetings facilitated by Councilmembers.
- Advisory Committees – the City may utilize one or more of its existing advisory committees for specialized aspects of community collaboration between City staff and the public.
- Developer Outreach – prior to formal submission of the initial application for a major development project such as those subject to public hearings, the City will require a developer to meet with adjacent property owners and others that may be impacted directly by a proposed project. A major development would be projects such as a large housing development (i.e., an apartment complex), site condominium, a planned development for a new mixed use, or commercial development next to a residential area. The Community Development Director will retain the ability to determine the applicability of this requirement, taking into account the scale of the proposed project, the type of application, and the potential impact to nearby properties, particularly residential neighbors. The City will work with the developer to identify potentially impacted neighbors adjacent or near the development up to the 300 feet from the development.

Communicating Results

The City of Jackson will publicly communicate all results of community input, and will utilize one or more of the inform methods listed above to relay results back to the public. The City of Jackson understands that this Public Participation Plan will need to be reviewed and updated as needed, at a minimum of every 5 years, in conjunction with the City's Master Plan.

Attachment A



Boards and Commissions



Boards & Commissions

Administrative Hearings Bureau

The purpose of the AHB is to improve the quality of life within the community and improve compliance with the applicable sections of the City's [Code of Ordinances](#). In furtherance of this goal, the City seeks to work in cooperation with residents through AHB proceedings to provide attractive neighborhoods through practical code enforcement.

Affordable Housing Development Board

The Affordable Housing Development Board (AHDB) was founded by the Jackson City Council to oversee affordable housing programs in the City of Jackson. The AHDB is tasked with administering the City's Affordable Housing Fund, preserving and developing affordable housing, and making recommendations to City officials on initiatives that create safe, dignified and affordable housing options in the City of Jackson.

Board of Review

Since 1893, the Board of Review (BOR) is a local committee of residents from the City of Jackson. The three BOR members are appointed to three-year terms by the City Council to receive and hear taxpayer appeals of the annual assessment roll. They are local taxpayers, property owners and peers of the average citizen who appear before them.

Brownfield Redevelopment Authority

The Jackson Brownfield Redevelopment Authority (JBRA) promotes the revitalization of environmentally distressed areas and facilitates the implementation of Brownfield Plans relating to the designation and treatment of Brownfield Redevelopment zones. The authority oversees the use of tax increment financing on select properties, that need special attention to be redeveloped. Taxes from these properties are captured to fund redevelopment.

Building Code Board of Examiners & Appeals

The Building Code Board of Examiners and Appeals (BCBA) provides an opportunity to request a variance including financial hardship or an opportunity to receive a final extension of time for completing repairs to code violations.

Community Police Oversight Commission

The Community Police Oversight Commission is tasked with further enhancing transparency and trust between the Jackson Police Department (JPD) and the community they service.

Downtown Development Authority

The mission of the Downtown Development Authority (DDA) is to encourage historic preservation, to create and implement development plans, to promote economic growth, and to correct and prevent deterioration in the district.

Ella W. Sharp Park Board

The Ella W. Sharp Park Board of Trustees oversees the property bequeathed to the City of Jackson in 1912. That property is now Ella Sharp Park, the City of Jackson's largest public park. The board oversees the park activities and progress based on Ella W. Sharp's requests in her will.

Environmental Commission

The City of Jackson Environmental Commission is tasked with helping to create a cleaner, greener future in Jackson. The Environmental Commission will develop comprehensive environmental policies for the City to protect and enhance its air, water and land quality. As an advisory body, the commission cannot enact policy, but will advise and make recommendations to the city council for review.

Historic District Commission

The Historic District Commission is tasked with functions concerning construction, alteration, repair, moving or demolition of a historic resource. In cooperation with other community organizations, it promotes Jackson history, heritage, traditions, and customs.

Human Relations Commission

Serves as an official agency of the City of Jackson, responsible for advising and making recommendations to the City Manager and City Council concerning good human relations, combating discrimination within the community wherever it exists, and for acting to promote needed change.

MLK Corridor Improvement Authority

The Jackson City Council created the MLK Corridor Improvement Authority, a group dedicated to redevelopment efforts along MLK Drive and Prospect Street. The MLK Corridor Improvement Authority is a ten-member board that directs planning and investments for this initiative.

Parks and Recreation Commission

The Parks and Recreation Commission oversees Parks, Recreation and the Recreation Millage through programs, maintenance and approved events.

Pension & Retirement Boards

Three boards exist: 1) Policemens and Firemens Pension Fund for City employees hired before July 1, 1973; 2) Act 345 Policemens and Firemens Retirement Plan; and 3) City Employees Retirement System.

Planning Commission

The Planning Commission works to develop and maintain a comprehensive plan that provides a vision of what the city will look like in 20 years. The commission also manages the city's zoning ordinance which is the main tool used to implement the comprehensive plan and regulate land use. Another responsibility of the commission is to review various types of development proposals within the city based upon the guidance provided by those resources.

Public Arts Commission

Jackson Public Arts Commission is an advisory body to the City Council with the goal to improve the quality of public spaces and make Jackson a better place to live and work.

Racial Equity Commission

This commission is tasked with reviewing City policies and procedures to ensure racial equity is a core element of government, along with making recommendations to officials on ways to promote racial justice and equity in Jackson.

Zoning Board of Appeals

The Zoning Board of Appeals (ZBA) shall hear and decide only such matters as the board is specifically authorized. The ZBA has the power to grant variances, decide appeals on administrative decisions, and to interpret the boundary lines of the zoning map.

Youth Council

The 15-member council, made of up middle and high school students, is tasked with making recommendations to the City Council concerning the needs of children, families, and young adults in Jackson. Members also work on innovative programs and initiatives that improve the quality of life for young residents and families in the community.